

①

* Tibbet Issue !:-

Q) Why Tibbet is Central to India - China relations? Why Dispute w.r.t Tibbet is often treated as the cause behind 1962 War?

Q) What has been India's policy towards Tibbet? Do you think that India needs to change its approach towards Tibbet?

* Importance of Tibbet for China !:-

- Beside Water and access to South Asia and Central Asia, Tibbet is important for Security of China as a Buffer Zone. Hence, China has always made claim over Tibbet.

* Modern History of Tibbet !:-

i) Modern History of Tibbet begins with British giving special Rights in Tibet.

In 1949, Communist were able to establish their control over Mainland China.

Mao has declared the intention to established Complete Control of China over Tibbet.

There has been an ambiguity w.r.t status of Tibet as Tibetans claimed themselves to be Autonomous State. By virtue Lhasa Convention India was one of the Party. India also had historical and cultural linkages. India had stakes in Tibet b/c of the British w.r.t Trade and otherwise, b/c of location of Sacred Sites. like - Kailash Mansarovar.

From the very beginning China looked at India with distrust as far as Tibet is concerned.

Tibetans opposed Chinese aims of Expansion of Communism. There is a Fundamental difference b/w Tibetan way of life and Communism.

a) Tibetans are highly Religious whereas Communism subjects the existence of God. Hence, this will allow West to develop the agenda of violation of Human Rights of Tibetans (Religious Freedom).

b) Chinese Communism (Maoism) is against Feudalism and Tibet is a Feudal Society.

What is Chinese Propaganda for Tibet? -

Chinese Propaganda is that they want to liberate Tibetan from serfdom. Under Chinese Communism, Tibet will become a Modern Society

• How Tensions started developing b/w India and China over Tibet :-

- In 1950, China occupied Tibet against w/c Tibetan started insurgency. China accused India working in Nexus with U.S.A to promote insurgency. China even presented the Reports showing CIA training Camps in Darjeeling.

• Background of Panchasheel Agreement, (1954) -

Main Agenda of the Agreement :-

- to bring clarity over the Status of Tibet i.e. what is the position of Govt. w.r.t Tibet.

What was the approach of Pt. Nehru ? :-

- Everyone in India knew that Tibet will become a cause of Conflict with China. Pt. Nehru wanted to Avoid the War. He believed that India needs peaceful Periphery to focus on Internal Development.

Hence, he tried to Passify China -

i) He clearly acknowledged Tibet as Chinese Territory.

ii) He has given up all special Rights India had in Tibet as a inheriten of British Raj.

Since, China has been accusing India for interference in the domestic affairs, India-China agreed for observing "Panchasheel".

Panchasheel was proposed by China. It was proposed as an alternative to Western tradition.

Western tradition looks at neighbours as a source of insecurity.

Panchasheel draws its inspiration from Buddhism. It represents Right Conduct. It gives alternative

Model for the Relations b/w the neighbours. The

Principles of Panchasheel are — "Respecting the Sovereignty and Territorial integrity of the State, Non-Interference in the domestic affairs, Mutual Respect, Non-Aggression and Peaceful Resolution on Conflict."

Panchasheel Agreement created the Environment of Co-operation b/w India and China. The spirit of Panchasheel was expressed through the slogans of "Hindi-Chini, Bhai-Bhai".

However, the environment of Bonhomie could not continue for long.

Why? —

— West will continue with its own propaganda

4

How Problems Started :-

- there was criticism in India against Nehru's approach. Nehru was criticised in the Parliament.

What were the main accusation against the Agreement ? -

- i) It was a one Sided Deal.
- ii) China has been the winner.
- iii) India didn't get anything in Concrete.

It was like a missed opportunity. India could have got better bargain.

What India got in the Agreement ? -

- Anti-Assurances.

What India could have bargain ? -

- India should have asserted its Special Rights in Tibet, like - Pakistan making itself as a Stakeholder for Kashmiris. India should also projected itself as a Stake Holder for Tibetans.

At least in exchange of India recognising China's Sovereignty over Tibet. India should have compelled China to recognise India's sovereignty over Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin.

At least, India should have bargained with China that China recognises POK as Indian Territory.

At the same Time, Govt came to know that China had built a road across Aksai-Chin.

Hence, to avoid domestic criticism, Pt. Nehru ordered to build Military Check-Posts in Aksai-Chin and NEFA.

↓
this is called by China as Nehru's "Forward Policy".

A/c to China, 1962 War was China's "Offensive Defence" (Pre-emptive War). A/c to China, India was planning to acquire Chinese Territories. China calls India "Imperialist Country". Hence, China took Pro-active step to defend its Territories.

→ (झड़प)
From 1957, itself, Skirmishes started on the borders. The Relation reach to its lowest point in 1959.

1959 - Escape of Dalai-lama from Tibet. India granting assylum to Dalai-lama. Not only Granting assylum, established the Provisional Govt. of Dalai-lama at Dharmashala (H.P.).

A/c to China, he could not have escaped w/o India's help. China accused India for violating Panchasheel. It means India interfered in the Domestic Affairs of China.

6

China considered itself as a Superior Nation.

China looks at other countries as Barbarian.

China looks at India as a Weak Civilisation.

China looks at India with disdain.

Hence, for China it became essentials to teach India lesson for its audacity.

All these developments resulted in the 1962 War.

Second test for India's policy of Non-Alignment.

India had to approach U.S.A for Military aid.

U.S.A had extended the Military support by sending its U.S.S. Enterprise to Bay of Bengal to pressurise China.

War resulted into a "Humiliating Defeat" for India, the memory of w/c still influence Indian Mindset while dealing with China.

China came to occupy Aksai-Chin as well as India's North East. later on, they have declared Unilateral & Ceasefire, withdrawn from North-East but continued to maintain their control over Aksai-Chin. The de facto Boundary in Aksai-Chin is known as LAC.

Why China had withdrawn from North-East?—

— B/c it would not have been possible for China to keep the territory under its control. People would not have accepted the Chinese occupation.

Why China retained Control over Aksai-Chin?—

(8)

i) Aksai-Chin is the only All weather Connecting Route, the Restive regions of China.

↳ (Tibbet & Xing-Xiang)

Hence, China would not have left the Regions. Regions also connects with PoK, w/c China would require in Future.

ii) Unlike North-East, Aksai-Chin have been No-Man land. Even Pt. Nehru ignored the security by suggesting that not even the blade of Grass grows in Aksain-Chin.

* India - China Relations Since 1962 War!—

1st Phase!— (1962 - 1979)

↳ this Phase defined as Cold Peace.

There was complete silence in Himalayas after 1962 war. All exchanges ended. Border trade was closed.

A/c to Jeff Smith, Cold Peace Prevailed. China got what it wanted. China got involved in its domestic issues.

↳ For E.g.!— Mao launched the programme of Great Leap Forward. Which was a complete failure. It resulted into Famine and Mass-Deaths.

There was domestic opposition to Mao. Hence, he started cultural Revolution, to kill his opponents.

What were the consequences of 1962 War for India ? —

- i) 1962 War became the basis for another war. It gave/boosted the morale of Pakistan, resulting into 1965 war.
- ii) It started changing the strategic Geography of South Asia. Pakistan started Engagement with China. It became the basis for U.S — China coming closer, creating huge pressure for India. India could not sustained the choice of remaining Non-Aligned. India had to seek the security Umbrella of U.S.S.R.
- iii) India's Foreign Policy started developing realist posture.
- iv) It has dented India's image among the developing countries or NAM countries.
- v) It has strengthen the China's image in the third World.

* 2nd Phase (1979-89) :-

1979 - Vajpayee as a Foreign Minister visited China to "Break the Ice". However, he had to return empty handed b/c the day he landed in China some day China committed Aggression on Vietnam. India - Russia and Vietnam had close Relations, so it was embarrassing for Indian Foreign Minister to stay back.

In 1987, India granted Statehood to Arunachal Pradesh. After which, we see Chinese incursion in Sum Do Rong Chu Valley. This has created New Tensions. Hence, in 1988 Rajiv Gandhi visited China. He was successful in breaking the Ice.

Rajiv Gandhi's visit can be considered as beginning of India's Look East Policy.

What were the factors leading to the visit? -
- By this time, it was clear that Cold War is coming to an end. USSR is going to disintegrate. India will require massive change in its Economic and Securities policies. Hence, India would have to improve Relations with neighbours.

What was the Achievement of the Visit? -

- i) Reiteration of the Spirit of Panchasheel. -
 - a) Resolution of Border dispute in a peaceful manner in the spirit of "Mutual Respect".

The visit resulted into the establishment of Joint Working Group consisting of Military officials to conduct the survey on Ground.

10

Why China agreed for Peaceful Resolution ?-
 - China wanted to focus on Internal Development for w/c peaceful Periphery is essential.

Q) Is China Really interested in the Resolution of Border dispute with India ? -

- Yes, Subject to the condition, it is dictated by China. However, it will not be feasible for India. Hence, if any solution is possible it is only through war.

If GoI wants to avoid war then it will have to convince its people for the compromise.

* What is the Future of India - China Relations ! -

- War is the only Future.

* Why China agreed for Joint Working Group ? -

- Deng Xiao Ping's Policy - it is called as 24 Character Policy. It means hide your capability by the time.

Rajiv Gandhi's visit led to the significant amount of normalisation of the Relations. There have been 8 Rounds of Talks. As per Media Reports, China offered Package Deal. It means if India accepts Chinese Sovereignty over Aksai - Chin, China will accept India's Sovereignty over Arunachal Pradesh.

12

* India - China Relations since the End of Cold War :-

1st Phase :- (1991 - 2003)

- the End of Cold War meant the beginning of New Cold War. The focus of USA shifted towards China. Till that time India and U.S. were also not close. Hence, India, China & Russia started coming together. They started calling for Multi-Polar World.

↳ It means challenging U.S. Hegemony.

India - China Trade Relations started improving.

1993 - Narasimha Rao's visit to China w/c resulted into 'peace and Tranquility Agreement' on Borders. In order to implement the Peace and Tranquility Agreement, India and China entered into Military CBM's (Confidence Building Measures, 1996).

↳ i) Till final solution, No party will attempt to alter the Status-Quo.

ii) Both party will ensure that Peace and Tranquility prevails on Borders.

- iii) No dangerous Military activities near borders.
- iv) Regular Flag Meetings.

* What was the impact of the Agreement?

— Result was Qualitative improvement in the Relations!—

- i) Increase in bilateral trade.
- ii) In 1998, when India tested Nuclear Weapon, despite pointing China as a Reason, China did not impose Sanctions against India whereas U.S. and Japan impose Sanctions.

Why China didn't impose Sanction against India?—

- B/c China were looking for India's Market.
- B/c China wanted to Communicate that even Nuclear Armed India is not a threat to China.
- For the First time, China's position on Kashmir was not Pro-Pakistan. In Kargil Crisis, China Advised Pakistan to act with restraint and to resolve the matter bilaterally through Dialogue.

2003!— Vajpayee's visit to China —

- ↳ - Vajpayee entered into Strategic Partnership with China.

Why India entered into Strategic Partnership with China?—

- B/c India was angry with U.S.
- India extended unconditional help to U.S.A in its Global War on Terrorism assuming that U.S.A will target Pakistan.

On the contrary, U.S.A made Pakistan the Frontline State, upgraded Pakistan to the level of Major Non-NATO Ally, extended Economic and Military Aid (F+16).

14